

1. Welcome & Purpose

Welcome to Meridian Analytics. This guide is designed to help external consultants quickly ramp, align with our operating model, and deliver high-impact work from day one.

Meridian works with a select group of consultants across product strategy, data, go-to-market (GTM), and operations. Our expectation is that external partners operate as extensions of our internal teams, with a strong emphasis on ownership, clarity, and execution.

2. Company Overview

Meridian Analytics is a B2B SaaS platform that enables organizations to turn data into actionable insights through modern analytics, embedded reporting, and decision intelligence tools.

Core Focus Areas

- Business Intelligence (BI) & dashboards
- Embedded analytics for SaaS platforms
- Data integrations across modern cloud stacks
- Emerging AI-driven insights and automation

Target Customers

- Mid-market and enterprise organizations
- SaaS companies embedding analytics into their products
- Data-driven teams across finance, operations, and product

Strategic Priorities (Current)

- Expand AI capabilities across the platform
 - Move upmarket into enterprise accounts
 - Improve product usability and onboarding
 - Scale embedded analytics offerings
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3. Key Stakeholders & Roles

Consultants are expected to understand and collaborate effectively with the following stakeholders:

Executive Leadership

- CEO (Chief Executive Officer)

Sets company vision, strategic priorities, and growth targets

- CPO (Chief Product Officer)

Owns product strategy, roadmap, and user experience

- CTO (Chief Technology Officer)

Oversees engineering, infrastructure, and technical architecture

- CRO (Chief Revenue Officer)

Responsible for sales, marketing, and revenue growth

Functional Leaders

- VP Product / Product Directors

Define product initiatives, requirements, and prioritization

- Engineering Leads

Own technical execution and delivery timelines

- Sales Leadership

Provide market feedback, pipeline insights, and customer needs

- Customer Success (CS) Leadership

Represent customer health, retention risks, and feature gaps

- Strategy & Ops Team

Coordinate planning, OKRs, and cross-functional alignment

Primary point of contact for most consultants

Engagement Ownership

Each consultant will be assigned:

- Executive Sponsor (strategic alignment)
 - Functional Lead (day-to-day direction)
 - Ops Partner (coordination, tracking, and escalation)
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4. Data Access Procedures

Access Principles

- Least privilege access — only what is required for your scope
 - Time-bound access — aligned with engagement duration
 - Auditability — all access is logged and monitored
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Systems Commonly Used

Depending on your engagement, you may be granted access to:

- Data warehouse (e.g., Snowflake / BigQuery)
 - BI tools and dashboards
 - CRM (e.g., Salesforce)
 - Product analytics tools
 - Internal documentation (Notion, Google Drive)
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Access Process

1. Access Request Submission
 - Submitted by internal sponsor via IT/Ops
 - Includes scope, duration, and justification
2. Security Approval
 - Reviewed by IT/Security team
 - May require NDA and compliance acknowledgment
3. Provisioning
 - Credentials issued via secure channels
 - Multi-factor authentication (MFA) required
4. Verification
 - Consultant confirms access and functionality
 - Report any issues within 24 hours

Data Handling Guidelines

- Do not export or store sensitive data outside approved systems
- Use company-approved tools for analysis and storage
- Immediately report any suspected data issues or breaches
- Access will be revoked upon engagement completion

5. Deliverable Standards

Meridian expects consultant outputs to meet a consistent, high-quality standard.

Core Expectations

- Structured and clear — logical flow, executive-ready
- Actionable — includes recommendations, not just analysis
- Data-backed — supported by credible data and assumptions
- Concise — avoid unnecessary complexity

Common Deliverable Types

- Strategy documents (market analysis, product strategy)
- Operational frameworks (playbooks, process design)
- Data analysis and dashboards
- Executive presentations

Formatting Guidelines

- Use clean, professional formatting (Google Docs, Slides, etc.)
- Include:
 - Executive summary
 - Key insights
 - Recommendations
 - Supporting data/appendix
- Clearly label:
 - Assumptions
 - Risks

- Open questions

Review Process

- Draft review with functional lead
- Iteration based on feedback
- Final review with executive sponsor (if applicable)

6. Billing & Engagement Guidelines

Engagement Models

- Fixed-fee projects
- Time & materials (hourly or daily rates)
- Milestone-based payments

Time Tracking (If Applicable)

- Submit weekly time logs
- Include:
- Hours worked
- Workstream/project
- Brief description of activities

Invoicing

- Standard billing cycle: Monthly
- Invoice requirements:
- Engagement name
- Billing period
- Breakdown of services
- Total amount due
- Payment terms: Net 30 unless otherwise specified

Scope Management

- Work must align with agreed scope of work (SOW)
- Any scope changes require:
- Written alignment with internal sponsor
- Updated SOW or addendum (if material)

Performance Expectations

- Meet agreed timelines and milestones
- Proactively communicate risks or delays
- Maintain professional standards in all interactions

7. Communication Protocols

Core Principles

- Transparency: Share progress, risks, and blockers early
- Responsiveness: Timely replies (within 24 hours on business days)
- Clarity: Communicate decisions and next steps clearly

Primary Communication Channels

- Email: Formal updates, deliverables, and external communication
- Slack: Day-to-day coordination and quick questions
- Meetings (Zoom/Google Meet): Reviews, alignment, and decision-making

Meeting Cadence (Typical)

- Weekly Check-In (30–60 min)
- Progress updates
- Risks and blockers
- Next steps
- Working Sessions (as needed)
- Deep dives with functional teams
- Executive Reviews (as applicable)
- Milestone updates
- Strategic alignment

Status Updates

Consultants are expected to provide weekly written updates including:

- Progress against deliverables
- Key accomplishments
- Risks or blockers
- Planned work for next week

Escalation Protocol

If issues arise:

1. Raise with functional lead
2. If unresolved, escalate to Ops Partner
3. If critical, escalate to Executive Sponsor

8. Engagement Success Criteria

A successful consultant engagement at Meridian is defined by:

- Clear, actionable deliverables
 - Strong alignment with internal stakeholders
 - On-time execution
 - Measurable impact on business outcomes
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9. Offboarding Process

At the end of the engagement:

- Final deliverables submitted and approved
 - Knowledge transfer completed (if applicable)
 - System access revoked
 - Final invoice submitted
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10. Key Takeaways

- Operate as an extension of Meridian's internal team
 - Focus on clarity, execution, and impact
 - Communicate proactively and transparently
 - Deliver high-quality, actionable outputs
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We're excited to partner with you. Welcome to Meridian Analytics.